



Into obscurity: Mumbai FC (left), former winners of the I-League 2nd Division and MDFA Elite League, folded in 2019, while the institutional side HAL (right) struggled to adapt and faded from top-tier football. K. MURALIKUMAR

participating in the I-League 2nd Division. It won the KPL once in the 2000–01 season and clinched the Kerala State Club Football Championship 10 times. Despite these achievements, the club shut down operations in 2015 due to financial issues and a lack of proper player recruitment.

Bharat FC, Maharashtra
I-League | Disbanded in 2015

Kalyani Bharat FC, also known as Bharat FC, was founded in 2014 by the Kalyani Group in Pune. It was a direct-entry team into the I-League, playing its home games at the Balewadi Sports Complex. Despite initial investment, the club competed for only one season, finishing 11th in 2014–15, before being dissolved due to concerns over financial viability.

Royal Wahingdoh, Meghalaya
I-League, I-League 2, Shillong Premier League | Disbanded in 2016

Based in the foothills of Meghalaya, Royal Wahingdoh was founded in 1946 as Wahingdoh Sports Club. Nicknamed the 'Royals', the club played one season in the I-League and was a regular in the Shillong Premier League. In fact, the team won three consecutive SPL titles from 2010 to 2012. Wahingdoh's best achievement came

in 2014 when it won the I-League 2 title and earned promotion to the I-League. The team finished in third position in the 2014–15 I-League season, but decided against playing the following season despite receiving a national licence, due to the financial toll and lack of direction in the league.

Pune FC, Maharashtra
I-League | Disbanded in 2016

Owned by the Ashok Piramal Group, Pune FC was formed in 2007 and played two seasons in the I-League 2 before gaining promotion to the then top tier in 2009. The team's best result came in the 2012–13 season, when it finished second in the standings. However, financial troubles forced the club to shut down ahead of the 2015–16 season, with ISL club FC Pune City acquiring the Pune FC academy and rebranding it under its name.

Mumbai FC, Maharashtra
I-League | Disbanded in 2017

Founded in 2007, Mumbai FC competed in the I-League after gaining promotion to the top tier by winning the I-League 2nd Division in 2008. It also took part in the MDFA Elite League (now known as the Mumbai Premier League) and lifted the title in the 2010–11 season. The

team, however, failed to find success in the I-League under then-coach Khalid Jamil and was eventually relegated in 2017, after years of financial problems. Instead of playing in the second division, the club's operations were shut down and it was subsequently disbanded in 2019.

DSK Shivajians FC, Maharashtra
I-League | Disbanded in 2017

Established in 1987 as Shivajians Sports Club in Pune, this community team dominated local football for two decades. In 2013, the DSK Group took over and renamed it. The club gained direct entry into the I-League in 2015 and notably partnered with Liverpool FC for a residential academy. It clinched a record 22 Pune Football League titles. However, its two-season stint in the I-League concluded in 2017 when the DSK Group's financial difficulties led to the club's withdrawal and eventual closure.

Delhi Dynamos, Delhi
ISL | Disbanded in 2019

Delhi Dynamos was one of the eight clubs to take part in the inaugural ISL season in 2014. The side competed in the top tier for five seasons, reaching the knockout stages twice (in 2015 and 2016). Ahead of the 2019–20 season, the club was rebranded as Odisha FC, and its base of operations was shifted to Bhubaneswar.

FC Pune City, Maharashtra
ISL | Disbanded in 2019

Like the Dynamos, FC Pune City was one of the founding clubs of the ISL. The team made it past the group stage only once in its five-year history, in the 2017–18 season, before losing to Bengaluru FC in the semifinal.

In 2019, the club was involved in a controversy after trying to sign Spaniard Néstor Gordillo from Chennai City FC while he was still under contract. The AIFF handed Pune City a two-window transfer ban, a two-year ban from participating in any AFC tournaments, along with fines. This forced the club to be dissolved within months and be replaced by Hyderabad FC in the tournament.